

Saladin

The man who took
JERUSALEM from the Crusaders
Saladin was a great Muslim leader who retook
the Holy Land and who, despite his fearsome
reputation, treated his enemies with respect.

The young warrior

Saladin was born in Mesopotamia
(modern-day Iraq) in 1138. As a young
man, he helped his uncle, a general for
the Sultan of Syria, win a **great victory**
against the Crusaders. His uncle became
ruler of Egypt and, when he died, **Saladin**
took power for himself.



The name
"Crusaders" comes
from "crux" (Latin
for cross) because
they carried the
cross with them
as a symbol.

A clash of religions

Jerusalem was a very important city to **Jews**,
Christians, and **Muslims**. For centuries, its
Arab rulers had allowed Christian and Jewish
pilgrims into the city. However, by 1095,
the Muslim rulers of Jerusalem were making
travel to the city more difficult for pilgrims.
The crusades were started by the Christians
to **RETAKE JERUSALEM**.

In Arabic, Saladin means "Righteousness of faith"



He couldn't have done it without...



Muslims believe that **MUHAMMAD**
(570–632) ascended to heaven
at **DOME OF THE ROCK**. Saladin
used the Dome as a symbol
to unite the Arabs to his cause.